Like the early art of the Vedics, Shunga art features many-limbed gods in symbolic dress and pose. It's easy to see how the dominant successor to the Maurya Empire protected much of future India from the changes wrought by Greek cities and kingdoms in the north, primarily in terms of religion. During this period, Hinduism reigned among the many religious and spiritual paths that characterized that part of the world, so much so that it ceased to be considered a religion so much as it was a way of living to honor the traditions of one's predecessors.

Both the north and south of India were affected economically by the Greek presence in the Middle East, and the whole of the subcontinent used coins struck from a variety of fine metals, including copper and gold. The northern varieties were usually round as per the Greek standard; those in the south retained their classical Indian features and were usually square. The coins featured Hellenistic emperors and Hindu gods, two languages, Greek and Sanskrit. These were used in trade not only within the Greco-Indian kingdoms but also as far away as China.

In approximately 125 BCE, the Greco-Indian constructs were partially conquered by Scythians from eastern regions of Asia. This caused the Greeks to abandon Bactria and move farther south into central India. By the 1st century CE, the Yuezhi tribes of China established the Kushan Empire in what had once been Indo-Greek and Greco-Bactrian strongholds. Once more, the Greeks were removed from the subcontinent—and this time, they would not return.